Preparing and delivering a public speech can be challenging. You can find it difficult to decide what you want to say, or how to say it. To some, perhaps the very thought of speaking before an audience is frightening. With guidance and practice, anyone can write and deliver a speech successfully.

Making a short formal speech involves three stages:

- ☐ Planning
- ☐ Writing
- ☐ Delivery

Planning Stage

The content of your speech and how you deliver it will depend on three important factors:

- ☐ Occasion / Situation
- ☐ Audience
- ☐ The purpose of your speech

Writing stage

- ☐ This stage involves the following:
- ☐ Creating an outline
- ☐ Collecting the material required
- ☐ Preparing the first draft
- ☐ Editing for correctness, cohesiveness etc.

Remember the following points while delivering a speech:

Your appearance – you must be well–groomed.

Be clear and audible.

Adjust your pace of delivery – pause when necessary.

Make eye contact with members of the audience and sustain it to win the trust and confidence of your listeners.

Be natural in your gestures and posture– avoid distracting mannerisms (for e.g., keeping one's hands in one's pockets).

Some other situations when a short formal speech is made are mentioned below:

To welcome a guest at a function

To bid farewell to someone leaving an institution/organization or

To propose a vote of thanks at the close of a formal event

Phrases used when delivering a welcome address are given below.

Opening courtesies	Giving the background	Introducing the theme/ purpose
Good morning/afternoon /evening	The idea took birth a year ago…	This gathering offers us a diverse platform to…
Let me first welcome…	In the last meeting, we discussed the possibility of…	Let us take the first step towards…
I feel privileged to welcome	We were exploring the possibility of…	The initiative to… will go a long way in creating…
I would like to welcome…	There was a need felt to work together on…	Today's function marks…

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